

# Testability

Quentin Crain

[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Software\\_testability](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Software_testability)

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Testability is the property of a software system that lets you write, run, and judge tests against it economically — the degree to which the code admits the operations testing requires. It is established as a quality attribute in ISO/IEC 25010 (under maintainability) and treated as a first-class architectural concern by Bass/Clements/Kazman, with the canonical decomposition coming from Robert Binder: controllability (driving the SUT into needed states), observability (seeing what it did), predictability (determining expected outputs from inputs), and decomposability (isolating the part under test); James Bach's "Heuristics of Software Testability" covers similar ground from a practitioner angle. Testability is a property of the production code, not of the test suite — which is what distinguishes a testability requirement (a constraint on the implementation, e.g. "log every function entry with arguments and a correlation ID") from a test requirement in the Ammann/Offutt sense (an obligation a coverage criterion places on the tests themselves). A sharper way to hold it: testability is

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